DESIGN

Zerado — Landing Page Design Blueprint

ForgePlay deliverable · engineered artifact

FlowForge
ENGINEERED ARTIFACT

DRAWING TITLE

Zerado — Landing Page Design Blueprint

DISCIPLINE	SHEET	DWG NO.	REV	STATUS
DESIGN	01 OF 12	FP-LP-DESIGN-01	A · 2026-08-24	IN REVIEW

LEGEND — Ink — text & headings · Canvas — surface · Accent — emphasis · Highlight — rules

Rendered from blueprint.md

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This document is normative. Where it and an improvisation disagree, this document wins. Where it and `brand/brand-manual.md` disagree, the brand manual wins — this blueprint *applies* brand tokens, it never invents colour or type. Where it and `ratification/mock.outline.md` disagree on structure, the ratified outline wins.

The machine-readable half of this contract is `design/blueprint.tokens.json`. Both were written together; if they ever drift, the JSON is the one the gate reads and this file is the one a human reads, and the drift is a defect in this deliverable.

§01 1 · Conformance header

```
ratifies:  ratification/mock.outline.md
sha256:    a2bc87e434f4035a7dd851dacadb8aee0961d66f5e58465b18f9640b20248ecb
(verified 2026-08-24)
applies:   brand/tokens.css · brand/tokens.json · brand/brand-manual.md
(rev A)
wires:     content/landing-copy.md (rev A, "final — implement verbatim")
head data: content/seo.md (title, meta description, canonical, OG, Twitter)
— used verbatim
sections:  16 present · 16 ratified · 0 added · 0 dropped · 0 reordered
```

1.1 Section inventory — all sixteen, in the ratified order

#	ID	RATIFIED HEADING SOURCE	LAYOUT FAMILY
01	`hero`	H1 from copy §01	Copy column + full-width terminal frame
02	`maker-line`	*(no heading — one line)*	Single centred rule-flanked line
03	`the-problem`	"The problem" (copy §03, optional heading — **rendered**)	Three-line stack, narrow measure
04	`moods`	"Sorted by mood, not genre"	Intro + 4-card grid + terminal frame
05	`states`	"Where each game stands"	Intro + 4 state chips in a row
06	`one-collection`	"One collection, everything you own"	Two text halves + 12-tile cover grid
07	`price-intelligence`	"When to buy, not just what to buy"	Intro + single price card, centred
08	`yours-and-offline`	"It's yours, and it's offline"	Three trust points
09	`terminal-first`	"Built for the terminal, on purpose"	Body + game-detail terminal frame
10	`and-on-your-phone`	"And on your phone, later"	Body + two phone frames
11	`community`	"The community layer — Phase 4, not built yet"	Phase badge + body + muted example panel
12	`roadmap`	"Roadmap"	Horizontal 4-phase track
13	`after-phase-4`	"After Phase 4 — ideas, not promises"	Quiet single block, dashed frame
14	`faq`	"Questions"	Six `<details>` rows
15	`closing-cta`	*(no heading — line + button)*	Centred single-action block
16	`footer`	*(no heading)*	Three-band footer

Order is DOM order. The build emits these sixteen `<section>` elements as immediate children of `<main>` (with §16 in `<footer>`), in exactly this sequence, each carrying `id` equal to the ratified id above. That id is the conformance handle the gate reads.

1.2 Global constraints this design commits to

CONSTRAINT	VALUE	WHY IT IS IN THE DESIGN, NOT JUST THE BUILD
JavaScript	**none**	Everything on this page is achievable without it: two links, a `mailto:`, a native `<details>` accordion, CSS animation. Zero JS makes INP effectively free and removes a whole class of failure. It is a design decision because it forbids any component that would need script.
Raster images	**zero**	No `.png` / `.jpg` / `.webp` anywhere. Every "image" on this page is composed HTML/CSS or an inline/linked SVG that already exists in `site/public/`.
External requests	**zero**	Fonts, logos and favicon are same-origin. No CDN, no analytics, no embed, no web font service.
Horizontal page scroll	**forbidden at every breakpoint**	`<body>` never scrolls sideways. Anything wider than its container scrolls *inside its own box*. See §5.5.
Scroll-triggered animation	**none**	Reveal-on-scroll costs CLS risk and reads as 2016 marketing. The page is composed to be good when static.
Colour scheme	dark-native, not conditional	Per `tokens.css`: the dark palette is `:root` and there is no light mode on this page.

§02 2 · Section-by-section layout spec

Notation: `≥1280` / `768–1279` / `<768` are the design's three reflow bands; the four *measured* viewports are 375 / 768 / 1280 / 1920 (§5). Copy references are to `content/landing-copy.md` by its section number — the build pulls strings from there and never retypes them.

Grid: a 12-column grid inside `--z-container-max` (1180px) with `--z-gutter` (24px). At 1280 a single column measures 76.33px. `--z-container-narrow` (760px) is the prose measure column.

§01 hero

```
≥1280
┌──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┐
│  [nav: lockup ···································· GitHub · CTA ]         │
│                                                                          │
│  cols 1–7 ──────────────────────────────┐    cols 8–12: empty            │
│   PICK A MOOD.                          │    (negative space is          │
│   GET A GAME.                           │     the composition —          │
│   PLAY IT TONIGHT.                      │     see note below)            │
│   <subhead, 19px, max 68ch>             │                                │
│   [ Join the waitlist ] [ View on GitHub ]│                              │
│   <microcopy 15px>                      │                                │
│  ──────────────────────────────────────────────────── grid horizon ──────│
│   ┌── cols 1–12 · TerminalFrame TF-1 "library" · two-pane ──────────┐    │
│   │ zerado — library                        412 games · 6 zerado    │    │
│   │ ▒▒▒▒ scanner track (parked pip)                                 │    │
│   │ ◐ Hollow Knight    STEAM  42h IN PROGRESS │ TONIGHT            │    │
│   │ ◉ Celeste          STEAM  11h ZERADO      │  ○ NOT STARTED 288 │    │
│   │ ○ Disco Elysium    GOG     0h NOT STARTED │  ◐ IN PROGRESS   9 │    │
│   │ ⊘ Dark Souls III   STEAM   6h ABANDONED   │  ◉ ZERADO        6 │    │
│   │ ◐ Hades            STEAM  28h IN PROGRESS │  ⊘ ABANDONED   109 │    │
│   │ ○ Chrono Trigger   PHYSICAL — NOT STARTED │                    │    │
│   │ ↑↓ move · enter open · m mood · / filter · q quit              │    │
│   └──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘   │
│  <figcaption — the mockup disclosure, verbatim from copy §01 alt>        │
│  ═══════════════ ScannerRule (the page's one animation) ═══════════════│
└──────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────────┘
```

- **Copy column is cols 1–7 and stops there.** Columns 8–12 stay empty. This is deliberate: an expensive object is mostly surface. Filling that space with a badge cluster or a second graphic is what makes a page look like a template.

- **The image slot is full width and below the copy**, exactly as copy §01 specifies ("full width, below the fold line"). It is not a side-by-side split — the ratified copy already made that call.
- **Backdrop:** `GridHorizon` (§7.4) occupies the hero's bottom 38%, masked to zero opacity above that line. **No text is ever composited over it** — the terminal frame that overlaps it is an opaque `--z-bg` surface with its own border.
- **LCP element is the H1 text.** Nothing above it loads an image, because there are no images.

BAND	BEHAVIOUR
≥1280	As drawn. Frame two-pane, 125 mono columns at 15px (80 list / 3 divider / 42 rail).
768–1279	Copy column spans full container. Frame single-pane, list only (the TONIGHT rail is dropped, not shrunk), 87 columns at 13px.
<768	Everything full width. Frame rows go **two-line** (§7.3) so the state label is never dropped — the co-render rule (colour + glyph + label) survives 375. 39 columns at 13px.

Content slots — H1 copy §01 headline, rendered as three block-level `<span>`s breaking after each sentence (measured: this is the only wrap that fits 375 — see §4.2); subhead copy §01; `CTAButton primary` → `mailto:alex@flowforgesoft.com?subject=Zerado-WaitList`; `CTAButton secondary` → `https://github.com/JustCode-CruzAlex/Zerado`; microcopy copy §01; figure caption = copy §01 alt text, verbatim and visible.

§02 `maker-line`

One line, copy §02, at `--z-text-lg` (19px), `--z-text-secondary`, centred in `--z-container-narrow`, flanked left and right by a 1px `--z-border` hairline that runs to the container edge. Vertical rhythm `--z-space-7` (48px) top and bottom rather than the full `--z-section-y` — this is a credential, not a section, and it should feel like a caption between two big moments. `Zerado` and `FlowForge` render in `--z-text` (16.65:1) so the two product names lift out of the sentence without needing colour.

All bands identical; only the horizontal padding changes.

§03 `the-problem`

Heading "The problem" rendered as the section H2 but at the **small** end of the H2 clamp (§4.3 `.z-h2--quiet`), because the copy marks it "optional, small". Below it, three lines from copy §03 as a `ProblemStack`: each line its own block at `--z-text-lg` (19px), 1.6 line-height, separated by `--z-space-3`, in `--z-text`. The three lines are a crescendo, so line 3 is the only one that wraps at any breakpoint — set the measure to `--z-container-narrow` and let it.

A single amber vertical rule (`2px`, `--z-primary`, full height of the stack) sits at the left edge with `--z-space-5` of space before the text. That is the whole treatment. No imagery, per the ratified outline.

All bands: stacked, narrow measure. At <768 the amber rule stays (it costs 2px + 24px = 26px of a 335px budget and it is the section's only ornament).

§04 `moods`

H2 copy §04, intro line copy §04 at 19px, then:

- **MoodCard × 4** — grid of 4 at ≥1280, **2×2 at 768–1279**, 1 column at <768. Each card: `--z-surface-raised` fill, 1px `--z-border-strong` edge, `--z-radius-md` (4px), padding `--z-space-5`. Title at `--z-text-h3` (23px, Space Grotesk 700, `--z-text`), body at `--z-text-base` (17px, `--z-text-secondary` — 8.41:1 on raised). Titles and bodies verbatim from copy §04 cards 1–4, in order.
- A **mono index** (`01` – `04`, `--z-text-readout`, `--z-text-tertiary`) sits top-right of each card. Cockpit annotation, not decoration — it is how a terminal labels a choice list.
- **Cards are not interactive** and carry no hover state. See §6.1.
- **TerminalFrame TF-2 "mood picker"**, `still` variant, below the grid, full container width.

§05 `states`

H2 copy §05, intro line, then **StateChip × 4 in one row** at ≥768 and a vertical list at <768. Each chip is `glyph + LABEL + line`, drawn straight from the brand's state quad (`brand/tokens.json` `color.state`):

#	COLOUR TOKEN	GLYPH	LABEL	LINE SOURCE
1	`--z-state-not-started` `#A5A29B`	○	NOT STARTED	copy §05 state 1
2	`--z-state-in-progress` `#FFB000`	◐	IN PROGRESS	copy §05 state 2
3	`--z-state-zerado` `#19E0FF`	◉	ZERADO	copy §05 state 3
4	`--z-state-abandoned` `#C77DFF`	⊘	ABANDONED	copy §05 state 4

State 3 is the payoff and is composed differently on purpose. Its chip spans wider (it holds a long explanatory line), gets `--z-glow-cyan` as the page's *only* glow, and its glyph renders one step larger. This is the moment the product name explains itself; the composition should notice. The italicised first appearance of *zerado* required by `content/landing-copy.md`'s casing rule lives in this line.

At <768 the four chips stack; chip 3 keeps the glow and stays last-but-one in reading order — the ratified order is Not Started · In Progress · Zerado · Abandoned and it does not change.

§06 `one-collection`

H2 copy §06, then two halves, then the tile grid.

- **Halves:** ≥1280 two columns 50/50 (`connected stores` | `physical shelf`), 768–1279 two columns 50/50, <768 stacked. Each half gets a mono `readout` overline. The overlines are the ratified half-names from the outline (`CONNECTED STORES`, `THE PHYSICAL SHELF`) rendered uppercase in `--z-text-readout`.
- **StoreRow list** inside the first half — Steam marked live, PlayStation/GOG/EA marked planned. Live = ◉ + `--z-accent`; planned = ○ + `--z-text-tertiary` (5.53:1 on raised). `--z-cyan-900` was rejected for the planned rows: 2.87:1, fails as text (§8.3).

- **CoverGrid** — 12 `CoverTile`s. Full spec in §7.5. Columns: **3 at 375, 4 at 768, 6 at ≥1280.** 12 divides cleanly into all three (4 rows / 3 rows / 2 rows) so the shelf never ends on a ragged row at any measured viewport.
- Figure caption: copy §06 alt text verbatim, **plus** one design-authored line — `Cover tiles are illustrative artwork, not real game covers.` (flagged in §7.5; content phase may re-word it, the requirement stands).

§07 `price-intelligence`

H2 copy §07, intro line, then **one PriceCard, centred, max 560px.** This is the section the outline calls "the one a skeptical visitor screenshots", so it gets the most compositional care per pixel of any component on the page.

```
┌─ PRICE CHECK ─────────────────────────────┐   ← mono readout overline
│                                           │
│   $15          TODAY                      │  ← 40px JetBrains Mono 700,
--z-primary
│   ───────────────────────────────────     │
│   $8           ALL-TIME LOW · 3 MONTHS AGO│  ← 23px mono, --z-steel
│                                           │
│                      sparkline (CSS bars) │
│                                           │
│   "$15, and in budget. It's been $8.      │  ← the verdict, 19px, --z-
primary
│    Maybe wait."                           │
└───────────────────────────────────────────┘
 Illustrative numbers. Price data comes from IsThereAnyDeal once Zerado
 is connected — nothing above is a live quote.        ← caption, copy §07
verbatim
```

- Every figure comes from copy §07's worked example — `$15`, `$8`, `three months ago`, and the verdict string verbatim. The design introduces no number the copy did not already state.
- **Verdict colour is `--z-primary` amber (9.53:1 on raised), not red.** `--z-scanner-500` measures 4.17:1 on `--z-surface-overlay` and fails as text, and the brand reserves it for motion and alarm. "Maybe wait" is a readout, not an alarm. Rejection recorded in §8.3.
- **Sparkline** is 16 CSS bars, `--z-amber-900` for the field with the two extremes lit (`--z-primary` for today, `--z-steel` for the low). Decorative, `aria-hidden`, carries no information not already in text.
- All bands: identical, centred, card max 560px; at 375 the card is full width (335px) and the `$15` / `$8` figures step from 40px/23px to 34px/19px mono.

§08 `yours-and-offline`

H2 copy §08, then **TrustPoint × 3**: 3 columns at ≥1280, 3 columns at 768–1279 (they are short), 1 column at <768. Each point's first sentence is its own line at `--z-text-h3` (23px, `--z-text`), the remainder at 17px `--z-text-secondary` — copy §08 supplies both halves in one paragraph each and the split is at the first period.

Each point is prefixed by a 2px × 24px amber tick rule rather than an icon. **No icon set is introduced anywhere on this page** (§7.7).

§09 `terminal-first`

H2 copy §09, body copy §09 at 19px in `--z-container-narrow`, then **TerminalFrame TF-3 "game detail"**, `still`, full container width, with its caption.

At ≥1280 the body sits in cols 1–6 and **cols 8–12 stay empty**, same as the hero. Echoing the frame's keybar into that space was considered and rejected — it would duplicate the frame's own footer two inches away. Two sections on this page use deliberate empty right-hand space, and they are the two sections that talk about the terminal; that is a rhyme, not a repetition.

§10 `and-on-your-phone`

H2 copy §10, body copy §10, then **PhoneFrame × 2**, side by side and slightly overlapped (the rear frame offset +32px x, +24px y, behind), centred.

- Frames are CSS only: 1px `--z-border-strong` outline, `--z-surface` fill, a 3px `--z-void` bezel inset, and a 28px corner radius. **28px is outside the brand's radius scale on purpose and it is declared as an exception** (`--z-phone-radius`): the scale is machined UI chrome, and this element depicts *hardware*, not chrome. A 4px-radius phone reads as a bug.
- Inside each: a 5-row list echoing the library — glyph + title + state label, at 13px mono. Same co-render rule.
- Both frames carry a `PhaseBadge` "PHASE 4" in the corner.
- Caption: copy §10 alt text, verbatim and visible.
- ≥768: side by side, overlapped. <768: **the rear frame is dropped entirely** (not shrunk) and one frame renders at 240px wide, centred. Two overlapping frames at 335px is mush.

§11 `community`

The section is stamped three separate ways, because the ratified decision makes this non-negotiable and one stamp is one thing to miss:

1. **The H2 says it** — copy §11's heading is used verbatim, with the clause "— Phase 4, not built yet" rendered in `--z-primary` amber inside the same heading element. Same text, emphasised.
2. **A `PhaseBadge` chip** sits above the H2: `⊘ PHASE 4 · NOT AVAILABLE YET`, mono readout, amber on `--z-surface-raised` (9.53:1), 1px amber border.
3. **The example panel is the `muted` TerminalFrame variant** — contents at 55% opacity over `--z-surface`, with a repeating diagonal watermark reading `PHASE 4` in `--z-chrome-500` at 0.14 alpha, `aria-hidden`, decorative only. Because the watermark is

low-contrast decoration, *it is never the only carrier* — stamps 1 and 2 both pass AA on their own.

Body copy §11 verbatim, including the premium-or-donation sentence. **There is no button, no link, no price and no tier name in this section** — `blueprint.tokens.json` records `"interactiveElements": 0` for §11 so the gate can assert it. The nearest link is in the footer and it is the affiliate disclosure text, not an ask.

Panel contents (three mini-panels: a comment thread, a review, a public profile), 2–3 lines each, generic handles (`@rafa`, `@kim`, `@sol`). ≥768 three across; <768 one column, all three kept.

§12 `roadmap` — the customer's required section

H2 "Roadmap", intro line copy §12, then the **RoadmapTrack**.

```
≥1280 — one row, four across, left to right
  ●————————●————————●————————●        ← 2px --z-border-strong rail,
  PHASE 1     PHASE 2     PHASE 3     PHASE 4     nodes 10px --z-steel rings
  CLI/TUI MVP Enrichment  Recommend…  Social…
  Your libr…  Covers, s…  What to b…  Sync, c…
  ○ PLANNED   ○ PLANNED   ○ PLANNED   ○ PLANNED
```

BAND	LAYOUT	WHY
≥1280	4 across, one row, horizontal rail	The ratified shape. 277px per card.
768–1279	**2 × 2 grid, reading order preserved left-to-right then down**	Measured: 4 across at 768 gives 168px per card, and "Recommendations" alone is 132px at 15px — the cards cramp. 2×2 keeps left-to-right time order (the whole reason the outline chose horizontal) without cramping.
<768	Vertical list, rail rotated to a left-hand vertical spine	The ratified fallback, verbatim: "stacking to a vertical list on narrow screens".

- **All four statuses read `Planned`. None is marked done.** Copy §12 says so and the outline makes it the honesty condition of the whole page.
- **No dates render** — decisions.md leaves dates open and the fallback is undated.
- **The status marker is built so that changing one phase is a token change, not a redesign.** `StatusMarker` consumes exactly four component tokens:

```
.z-phase { --z-status-color: var(--z-steel);      /* #A5A29B — 6.85:1 on raised */
           --z-status-track: var(--z-amber-900);  /* unlit; non-text only */
```

```
            --z-status-glyph: "○";
            --z-status-label: "PLANNED"; }
```

Marking Phase 1 shipped later means setting that one block to the brand's `zerado` state quad (`--z-cyan-500` / `◉` / `SHIPPED`) on `.z-phase[data-phase="1"]`. Colour, glyph and label all move together, so the co-render rule holds by construction and no layout changes.

- **`--z-amber-900` (#8A5E00) was rejected as the PLANNED label colour** — 3.06:1 on raised, fails body text. It survives as the *track* fill, which carries no text. Recorded in §8.3.

§13 `after-phase-4`

H2 copy §13, with "— ideas, not promises" in `--z-text-secondary` inside the heading (the same emphasis mechanic as §11, tuned the other way: §11 lifts its qualifier, §13 lowers it).

Body copy §13 in `--z-container-narrow`, inside a block with a **1px dashed `--z-border-strong` frame and no fill** — visually the quietest block on the page, and dashed because dashed reads as provisional in every technical drawing convention there is. No glow, no amber, no card elevation. It must not be mistakable for the roadmap directly above it.

All bands identical; narrow measure.

§14 `faq`

H2 "Questions", then **six `FAQItem`s** using native `<details>` / `<summary>` — no JavaScript.

- Question at `--z-text-lg` (19px, `--z-text`, Space Grotesk 600); answer at 17px `--z-text-secondary` (9.36:1), measure capped at `--z-measure` (68ch).
- Row separated by a 1px `--z-border` hairline (decorative use — between content blocks — which is the one thing `--z-border` is permitted to do).
- Marker is a mono `+` / `-` in `--z-primary`, right-aligned, rotating **not at all** (no rotation; the glyph swaps). Mechanical, per brand §7.2.
- **First item closed.** All six closed by default: an open first item implies the others are less important, and the questions are of equal weight.
- Questions and answers verbatim from copy §14, in the copy's order.
- All bands identical. At <768 the summary wraps to two lines and the marker stays on line 1.

§15 `closing-cta`

Line above the button (copy §15) at `--z-text-lg`, `--z-text`, centred, max 560px. One `CTAButton primary` → the same `mailto:` as §01, same label. Microcopy (copy §15) beneath at 15px `--z-text-tertiary`.

No secondary CTA here. The hero offers both; the close offers one. Splitting attention at the last ask is the standard way to lose it, and the ratified outline says "the same button, restated. No new promise."

Background: `--z-surface`, with a **static** scanner track (parked pip, no animation) as the section's top edge — the visual echo of the hero's live rule, at rest. One animation on the page means every other scanner is furniture.

§16 `footer`

Three bands inside `<footer role="contentinfo">`, separated by `--z-border` hairlines:

1. **Links band** — `Join the waitlist` · `View on GitHub` (copy §16's repeated links, no new strings), plus the contact line (copy §16) with `alex@flowforgesoft.com` as a `mailto:` link with no pre-filled subject (it is a contact address, not the waitlist).
2. **Disclosure band** — affiliate disclosure, copy §16 verbatim, at 15px `--z-text-secondary`. This is the page's only funding statement outside §11, and neither is a button.
3. **Company band** — "A FlowForgeSoft product." plus `PoweredByFlowForge`: `site/public/flowforge-logo.svg` at 28px (its viewBox is `0 0 36 36`) with the caption "Powered by FlowForge." at 13px `--z-text-tertiary`.

The Zerado lockup does **not** repeat in the footer — it is already in the nav, and repeating it next to the FlowForge mark creates a lockup-adjacency problem the brand's clear-space rule (§3.3) would then govern. One mark per page, plus the maker's mark.

≥768: three bands as horizontal rows with links left / company right. <768: everything stacks, links first.

2.1 Every link on the page

There are exactly **three** destinations and **nine** link instances. Together with the six FAQ disclosures that is **fifteen focusable elements on the whole page**. Nothing else is clickable.

INSTANCE	DESTINATION	VERIFIED
Nav CTA	`mailto:alex@flowforgesoft.com?subject=Zerado-WaitList`	decisions.md Q2
Nav secondary	`https://github.com/JustCode-CruzAlex/Zerado`	decisions.md: public, HTTP 200 anonymously
Hero CTA primary	`mailto:…?subject=Zerado-WaitList`	"
Hero CTA secondary	`https://github.com/JustCode-CruzAlex/Zerado`	"
§15 CTA	`mailto:…?subject=Zerado-WaitList`	"
Footer waitlist	`mailto:…?subject=Zerado-WaitList`	"
Footer GitHub	`https://github.com/JustCode-CruzAlex/Zerado`	"

INSTANCE	DESTINATION	VERIFIED
Footer contact	`mailto:alex@flowforgesoft.com` (no subject)	copy §16
Skip link	`#main`	element exists in this blueprint

No `href="#"`, no unbuilt routes, no anchor to a section that does not exist, no download link, no social icons, no donate or sponsor link anywhere. External links carry `rel="noopener noreferrer"`; the GitHub link opens in the same tab (a new tab is a decision made for the user, and this audience does not need it made for them).

FlowForge

DRAWING TITLE
2 · Section-by-section layout spec

SHEET 04 OF 12 | DWG NO. FP-LP-DESIGN-01 | REV A · 2026-08-24 | STATUS ● IN REVIEW

§03 3 · Applied brand tokens — colour role → surface mapping

Values are resolved from `brand/tokens.css`. **This blueprint applies; brand owns.** Ratios are measured with the WCAG 2.2 relative-luminance formula; the method reproduces all sixteen figures published in `brand-manual.md` §4.2 exactly (verified 2026-08-24), so the extended pairs below are on the same footing as the manual's own.

3.1 Surfaces

SURFACE	TOKEN	VALUE	USED BY
Page ground	`--z-bg`	`#05060A`	`<body>`, hero, §09, §13, terminal-frame screens
Section surface	`--z-surface`	`#0B0D14`	§02 §04 §06 §08 §12 §14 §15, footer
Raised	`--z-surface-raised`	`#141A24`	MoodCard, StateChip, PriceCard, PhaseCard, PhaseBadge, CoverTile plate ground
Overlay	`--z-surface-overlay`	`#1D2532`	hovered/focused card fill, terminal selected row

Sections alternate `--z-bg` / `--z-surface` rather than using dividers everywhere; the difference is 1.5% luminance, which is exactly the "one machined object, milled in steps" read and nowhere near a stripe.

3.2 Text on surface — the full applied matrix

FOREGROUND	#05060A	#0B0D14	#141A24	#1D2532
`--z-text` `#E9EEF5`	17.37	**16.65**	14.97	13.22
`--z-text-secondary` `#A9B5C7`	9.76	**9.36**	8.41	7.43
`--z-text-tertiary` `#8492A8`	6.42	**6.15**	5.53	**4.89** ← worst in system
`--z-primary` `#FFB000`	**11.05**	**10.59**	9.53	8.41
`--z-primary-hover` `#FFC94D`	13.23	**12.68**	11.40	10.06
`--z-accent` / link / focus `#19E0FF`	**12.68**	**12.15**	10.93	9.65
`--z-steel` `#A5A29B`	7.95	**7.62**	6.85	6.05
`--z-orchid-500` `#C77DFF`	7.53	**7.21**	6.49	5.73
`--z-scanner-300` `#FF6B6B`	7.30	**6.99**	6.29	5.55

Bold values are the figures published in `brand-manual.md` §4.2 and are cited, not recomputed. **Every text pair used anywhere on this page is ≥ 4.89:1. There is no AA-marginal text on this page and no AAA-only-if-large text.**

3.3 Role → surface, resolved

ROLE ON THE PAGE	TOKEN	VALUE
Body prose	`--z-text`	`#E9EEF5`

ROLE ON THE PAGE	TOKEN	VALUE
Supporting prose, FAQ answers, subhead	`--z-text-secondary`	`#A9B5C7`
Captions, microcopy, mono meta, planned-store rows	`--z-text-tertiary`	`#8492A8`
Headings H1/H2	`--z-text` on dark; the emphasised clause in `--z-primary`	`#E9EEF5` / `#FFB000`
Readout overlines, section eyebrows	`--z-text-tertiary`	`#8492A8`
Primary action fill	`--z-accent`	`#19E0FF`
Primary action label	`--z-accent-contrast`	`#05060A` (12.68:1)
Secondary action label	`--z-text`	`#E9EEF5`
Secondary action edge	`--z-border-strong`	`#64748B` (4.08:1, passes 1.4.11)
Focus ring	`--z-focus-ring`	`#19E0FF`, 2px, 2px offset — **never removed**
Card/control edge	`--z-border-strong`	`#64748B`
Content hairline	`--z-border`	`#2A3342` — decorative, **between content blocks only**
Terminal amber readout	`--z-primary`	`#FFB000`
Scanner track / pip	`--z-scanner-track` / `--z-scanner`	`#5C1414` / `#FF2E2E`
Grid horizon lines	`--z-grid-line`	`#1A2740` — decorative, never behind text

Why the primary CTA is cyan and the headings are amber. `tokens.css` names cyan "ACCENT — completion, the primary CTA" and amber "PRIMARY BRAND COLOUR", the ambient voice. Applied: amber is everywhere the machine is *talking* (headings, readouts, price figures, in-progress state); cyan appears exactly where something is *earned or completed* — the ZERADO state, the links, the focus ring, and the one action the page wants. On a page of amber readouts the single cyan button is the brightest, rarest thing on screen. That is the KITT cockpit argument, and it is why cyan does not get spent on decoration anywhere else.

3.4 Colour budget — the discipline that keeps it from becoming a light show

COLOUR	PERMITTED INSTANCES ON THE PAGE
`--z-accent` **cyan as a fill**	4 (three CTA buttons + the §05 `ZERADO` chip glyph)
`--z-glow-cyan`	**1** (the §05 ZERADO chip)
`--z-glow-amber`	**1 at a time** (hover/focus on one control) — per brand §4.6, never stacked
`--z-scanner` **animated**	**1** (the hero's bottom ScannerRule)
`--z-scanner` **static/parked**	4 (three terminal frame chrome bars + §15's top edge)

COLOUR	PERMITTED INSTANCES ON THE PAGE
`--z-orchid-500`	2 (the `ABANDONED` chip, and abandoned rows inside frames)

FlowForge

DRAWING TITLE

3 · Applied brand tokens — colour role → surface mapping

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§04 4 · Type scale

Families are `--z-font-display` (Orbitron), `--z-font-body` (Space Grotesk), `--z-font-mono` (JetBrains Mono), loaded by the already-staged `site/public/fonts.css` — 5 woff2 files, same-origin, correct `unicode-range` per subset, `font-display: swap`.

4.1 The ramp as applied

STEP	SIZE	LINE-HEIGHT	FAMILY	WEIGHT	TRACKING	CASE	WHERE
H1 (hero)	**clamp 30 → 52px**	1.08	Orbitron	700	0.03em	UPPER	§01 only
H2	**clamp 24 → 34px**	1.22	Orbitron	600	0.02em	UPPER	§03–§14 headings
H3	23px	1.22	Space Grotesk	700	0	Sentence	MoodCard titles, TrustPoint leads, price figures' labels
Body large	19px	1.60	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence	subhead, intros, §03 lines, FAQ questions (600)
Body	**17px**	**1.65**	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence	all prose — the floor
Body small	15px	1.60	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence	microcopy, footer disclosure
Caption	13px	1.50	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence	figure captions
Readout	13px	1.20	JetBrains Mono	500	0.18em	UPPER	eyebrows, overlines, tags, status labels
Terminal	13 / 15px	1.45	JetBrains Mono	400–500	0	as-is	inside TerminalFrame (§7.3)
Price figure	34 / 40px	1.0	JetBrains Mono	700	0	—	§07 only

`--z-text-display` (76px) is **not used on this page.** Nothing here earns it, and reaching for the biggest step because it exists is how a page starts shouting.

4.2 The Orbitron rules, and the one measurement that governs the hero

The brand's hard rule (§6.1): **Orbitron is display-only — never below 23px, never for prose, never more than about eight words, always uppercase, always tracked out.** Applied here:

- Orbitron appears in exactly two places: the H1 and the twelve H2s. Nothing else, ever.
- Smallest Orbitron on the page is **24px** (the H2 clamp floor) — above the 23px floor.
- H1 is 8 words; the longest H2 is 8 words. Both at the stated limit, neither over it.
- No Orbitron paragraph, no Orbitron button, no Orbitron in a terminal frame.

The hero H1 clamp is a measured value, not a taste value. Measured from the actual staged `site/public/fonts/Orbitron-latin.woff2` at `wght 700` with 0.03em tracking:

LINE	@34PX	@30PX	375 BUDGET
`PICK A MOOD.`	274.6px	242.3px	335px
`GET A GAME.`	262.5px	231.6px	335px
`PLAY IT TONIGHT.`	**359.6px — overflows**	**317.3px — fits**	335px

The brand's generic `--z-text-h1-fluid` bottoms out at 34px, and at 34px *this specific headline* blows through a 375px viewport by 24.6px. So the hero gets its own clamp, still far above the 23px Orbitron floor:

```
--z-h1-hero: clamp(1.875rem, 1.3053rem + 2.4309vw, 3.25rem);
/* resolves: 375 → 30.0px · 768 → 39.6px · 1280 → 52.0px · 1920 → 52.0px
(capped) */
```

And the H1 renders as three block lines, breaking after each sentence:

```
<h1><span>Pick a mood.</span><span>Get a game.</span><span>Play it tonight.
</span></h1>
```

Three reasons, in order of weight: (1) it is the only wrap that fits every measured viewport — natural wrapping at 1280 produces the orphan `TONIGHT.` on line 3; (2) the copy is three beats and should be typeset as three beats; (3) it is deterministic, so the gate can diff it. Screen readers read the heading as one string; the spans are `display:block` and add no semantics.

`--z-text-h2` clamp `clamp(1.5rem, 1.1rem + 1.7vw, 2.125rem)` resolves 24 / 30.7 / 34 / 34px. Measured worst case at 24px: the longest single word on the page (`COLLECTION,`) is 188.8px against a 335px budget. No H2 word overflows at any breakpoint.

4.3 Weight usage

Maximum three weights per family per surface, per brand §6.3:

- **Orbitron:** 700 (H1), 600 (H2). Two weights. 900 is never used.
- **Space Grotesk:** 400 (prose), 600 (FAQ questions, CTA labels), 700 (H3). Three weights.
- **JetBrains Mono:** 400 (terminal body), 500 (readouts, labels), 700 (price figures). Three.

Measured: JetBrains Mono's advance is exactly **0.600em** — 7.8px per cell at 13px, 9.0px at 15px. Every terminal column budget in §7.3 derives from that number.

---

§05 5 · Responsive breakpoints — 375 / 768 / 1280 / 1920

These four are the design's breakpoints **and** the quality gate's Playwright viewports. They are identical by requirement and must not diverge.

```
/* mobile-first; three media queries, no more */
@media (min-width: 768px)  { … }
@media (min-width: 1280px) { … }
@media (min-width: 1920px) { … }   /* container is already capped; this band only widens padding */
```

5.1 Per-breakpoint frame

	375	768	1280	1920
Page padding `--z-pad-x`	20px	24px	24px	24px
Content width	335px	720px	1180px (capped)	1180px (capped)
Grid columns	1	2	12	12
Section rhythm `--z-section-y`	64px	80px	96px	96px
Nav	lockup 120px + primary CTA; **no hamburger**	lockup 140px + both links	same	same
Terminal mono	13px / 39 cols	13px / 87 cols	15px / 125 cols	15px / 125 cols
Cover grid	3 cols	4 cols	6 cols	6 cols
Roadmap	vertical list	2 × 2	4 across	4 across
Mood cards	1 col	2 × 2	4 across	4 across
State chips	stacked	4 across	4 across	4 across
Phone frames	1 frame, 240px	2, overlapped	2, overlapped	2, overlapped

1920 is not a new layout. The container caps at 1180px and centres; the extra 740px is page ground. A design that keeps growing to fill a 1920 monitor stops being a designed object and becomes a stretched one. The only 1920-specific behaviour is that the hero's GridHorizon runs full-bleed to the viewport edge (it is a backdrop, not content), which is the one place the extra width buys something.

5.2 Nav behaviour — the no-hamburger decision

Two links do not earn a menu. At 375 the nav carries the lockup at its **measured 120px minimum** (`brand-manual.md` §3.4) plus the primary CTA, and the GitHub link drops to the footer, which already repeats both links per copy §16. Measured fit:

```
lockup 120 + clear-space gap 16 + CTA 171  =  307px   ≤  335px budget
✓
```

The 16px gap is not arbitrary: the lockup's clear space equals its cap height, which at 120px wide (viewBox `0 0 364 64`, cap height 48 units) is **15.8px**. 16px satisfies it with 0.2px to spare; nav vertical padding is 20px, which satisfies it above and below.

A hamburger would also cost the page its zero-JavaScript property for two links. Not worth it.

5.3 375 — the hardest viewport, checked element by element

ELEMENT	RISK	RESOLUTION	MEASURED
H1	Orbitron overflow	own clamp @30px + 3 explicit lines	317.3px ≤ 335 ✓
H2 (longest word `COLLECTION,`)	overflow	H2 clamp floor 24px	188.8px ≤ 335 ✓
Nav	crowding	lockup 120 + CTA, GitHub → footer	307px ≤ 335 ✓
Terminal frames	horizontal overflow	39-column budget + two-line rows	see §7.3 ✓
Roadmap track	4-across cramping	vertical list with left spine	✓
Cover grid	tile too small for its tag	3 cols → 106px tile; `PHYSICAL` tag = 62.4px + 12px plate padding	74px ≤ 106 ✓
Phone frames	two overlapped frames	rear frame dropped, one at 240px	✓
Price card	40px mono figures	step to 34px mono	✓
CTA pair	side-by-side buttons	**stack full-width**, 48px min height each	✓
FAQ summary	marker collides with wrapped text	marker in its own 32px grid column	✓

5.4 Touch targets

Every interactive element is **≥ 48 × 48px** at every breakpoint (WCAG 2.5.8 asks 24×24; 48 is the comfortable floor, and with only fifteen focusable elements on the page there is no reason to be tight). CTA buttons: 48px tall at ≥768, 52px at 375. FAQ `<summary>`: 56px minimum row. Footer links: 44px line-box with 16px spacing between adjacent targets.

5.5 The horizontal-overflow contract

`<body>` **never scrolls sideways at 375, 768, 1280 or 1920.** Three mechanisms, in order of preference:

1. **Reflow** — cards, chips, roadmap, cover grid, phone frames all change column count. First choice everywhere it is possible.

2. **Reformat** — terminal-frame rows become two-line at <768 rather than shrinking or dropping the state label. The co-render rule is preserved; the layout changes shape instead.
3. **Contained scroll** — as a *backstop only*, `TerminalFrame` sets `overflow-x: auto` on its screen element with `overscroll-behavior-x: contain`. If a future frame is authored wider than its budget, it scrolls inside its own box and the page still does not. The scroll container is keyboard-focusable (`tabindex="0"`) with a visible focus ring, so a keyboard user can reach it — a scrollable region that traps its content from keyboard users is a WCAG 2.1.1 failure.

Build assertion the gate can run: at each of the four viewports, per-element overflow: no element's bounding rect may exceed the viewport (`right ≤ clientWidth + 1`, `left ≥ -1`), excluding `aria-hidden` subtrees.

> ***Do NOT use*** ***`document.documentElement.scrollWidth === document.documentElement.clientWidth`****. `overflow-x: hidden` on the root pins those two values together, so that comparison is a tautology that cannot fail. It reported PASS at all four breakpoints while §02 was destroying 58% of its own text (QA BLOCKING-1). The per-element check above was mutation-tested: green at HEAD, red with the defect re-injected.*

---

§06 6 · Component inventory

Thirty components. Each row lists its states and the tokens it consumes. `focus-visible` is **load-bearing** — the brand states the focus ring is never removed, and a keyboard-first audience is this product's launch audience.

6.1 The interaction rule that governs the whole table

Only interactive elements get hover states. MoodCards, StateChips, CoverTiles, PhaseCards and TrustPoints do not lift, glow or change on hover, because they are not clickable and a hover affordance on a non-clickable element is a small lie that costs a click of trust. This page has exactly **seven interactive component types** — enumerated in §6.2 — across **fifteen focusable elements**, and they are the only things on the page that respond to a pointer.

6.2 Interactive components

COMPONENT	DEFAULT	HOVER	FOCUS-VISIBLE	ACTIVE	TOKENS
SkipLink	visually hidden, first in DOM	—	slides to top-left, `--z-accent` fill, `--z-accent-contrast` label, 2px ring	—	`--z-accent`, `--z-accent-contrast`, `--z-focus-ring`
CTAButton `primary`	`--z-accent` fill, `--z-accent-contrast` label (12.68:1), `--z-radius-md`, 48px tall, Space Grotesk 600 16px, no shadow	fill → `--z-accent-hover` `#8CF0FF` (label 15.45:1), `--z-glow-cyan`, 140ms `--z-ease-standard`	2px `--z-focus-ring` at 2px offset over page ground (ring vs both neighbours = 12.68:1) — ring is **additive to**, never a replacement for, the hover treatment	translateY(0), fill → `--z-accent`, 90ms	`--z-accent`, `--z-accent-hover`, `--z-accent-contrast`, `--z-glow-cyan`, `--z-radius-md`, `--z-duration-fast`
CTAButton `secondary`	transparent fill, 1px `--z-border-strong` edge, `--z-text` label (16.65:1)	edge → `--z-primary`, label → `--z-primary` (10.59:1), `--z-glow-amber`	same 2px cyan ring, 2px offset	edge → `--z-primary-hover`	`--z-border-strong`, `--z-primary`, `--z-glow-amber`

COMPONENT	DEFAULT	HOVER	FOCUS-VISIBLE	ACTIVE	TOKENS
NavLink (GitHub)	`--z-text-secondary` 15px	→ `--z-text`, 1px `--z-primary` underline offset 4px	2px cyan ring	—	`--z-text-secondary`, `--z-primary`
FAQItem (`details` / `summary`)	closed, question `--z-text` 19px/600, `+` marker `--z-primary`, 1px `--z-border` hairline below	question → `--z-primary`, marker → `--z-primary-hover`	2px cyan ring around the whole summary row	—	`--z-border`, `--z-primary`, `--z-duration-base` open / `--z-duration-fast` close
FooterLink	`--z-text-link` `#19E0FF` (12.15:1), no underline	underline 1px, colour → `--z-text-link-hover` `#8CF0FF` (14.81:1)	2px cyan ring, 2px offset	—	`--z-text-link`, `--z-text-link-hover`
TerminalFrame screen (scroll backstop only)	`tabindex="0"` only when its content overflows	—	2px cyan ring inset 2px	—	`--z-focus-ring`

Focus-ring geometry is constant everywhere: `outline: 2px solid var(--z-focus-ring); outline-offset: 2px`. On the cyan-filled primary button the 2px offset gap exposes the page ground between button and ring, so the indicator contrasts 12.68:1 against **both** its neighbours — which is what WCAG 2.4.13 actually asks. There is no case on this page where the ring sits directly against a colour it cannot be told apart from.

6.3 Non-interactive components

COMPONENT	STATES	TOKENS
Nav	static (not sticky — a fixed bar steals 72px of a 667px phone screen for two links)	`--z-surface`, `--z-border`
Logotype	one — `site/public/logo.svg`, 140px ≥768 / 120px at 375, clear space = cap height (15.8px @120, 18.5px @140). Never re-set in type, never glowed, never scaled part-wise (brand §3.7)	—

COMPONENT	STATES	TOKENS
SectionEyebrow	one — mono readout, zero-padded ratified index + ratified id, e.g. `04 · MOODS`	`--z-text-readout`, `--z-text-tertiary`
SectionHeading	one, with an optional emphasised trailing clause (`--z-primary` in §11, `--z-text-secondary` in §13)	`--z-font-display`, `--z-text`, `--z-primary`
Hero	one	`--z-bg`, `--z-h1-hero`
GridHorizon	static (decorative, `aria-hidden`)	`--z-grid-line`, `--z-primary` @6%
ScannerRule	`live` (hero only) · `parked` (reduced-motion, and all other instances)	`--z-scanner`, `--z-scanner-track`, `--z-glow-red`, `--z-duration-scanner`, `--z-ease-scanner`
TerminalFrame	`live` · `still` · `muted`	`--z-bg`, `--z-border-strong`, `--z-font-mono`, state quad
TerminalChrome	one (title + right-aligned counter + parked scanner track)	`--z-text-tertiary`, `--z-scanner-track`
TerminalRow	`default` · `selected` (`--z-surface-overlay` fill + `▸` caret) — **presentational only, not focusable**	state quad, `--z-surface-overlay`
MockupCaption	one	`--z-text-tertiary`, 13px
MakerLine	one	`--z-text-secondary`, `--z-border`
ProblemStack	one	`--z-text`, `--z-primary` (rule)
MoodCard	one (non-interactive)	`--z-surface-raised`, `--z-border-strong`, `--z-text`, `--z-text-secondary`, `--z-text-readout`
StateChip	four variants, one per state; variant 3 additionally `emphasised`	full state quad + `--z-glow-cyan` (variant 3 only)
StateLegend	one	—
StoreRow	`live` · `planned`	`--z-accent`, `--z-text-tertiary`
CoverTile	twelve fixed variants (§7.5); `physical` is a modifier of one of them	`--z-grid-line`, `--z-primary`, `--z-accent`, `--z-orchid-500`, `--z-steel`, `--z-surface`
PlatformTag	`store` (steel) · `physical` (amber + `▣`)	`--z-steel`, `--z-primary`, `--z-surface`
CoverGrid	one (`role="img"`, labelled by its caption)	—
PriceCard	one	`--z-surface-raised`, `--z-primary`, `--z-steel`, `--z-amber-900`
Sparkline	static, `aria-hidden`	`--z-amber-900`, `--z-primary`, `--z-steel`
TrustPoint	one	`--z-text`, `--z-text-secondary`, `--z-primary`

COMPONENT	STATES	TOKENS
PhoneFrame	one; `--z-phone-radius: 28px` declared exception	`--z-surface`, `--z-void`, `--z-border-strong`
PhaseBadge	one	`--z-primary`, `--z-surface-raised`
CommunityPanel	one (`muted`)	`--z-chrome-500` @0.14 watermark, `--z-surface`
RoadmapTrack	`4up` · `2x2` · `vertical`	`--z-border-strong` (rail), `--z-steel` (nodes)
PhaseCard	one	`--z-surface-raised`, `--z-border-strong`
StatusMarker	driven entirely by `--z-status-color` / `-track` / `-glyph` / `-label`; ships as `PLANNED` on all four	`--z-steel`, `--z-amber-900`
SpeculationBlock	one	dashed `--z-border-strong`, `--z-text-secondary`
ClosingCTA	one	`--z-surface`, `--z-scanner-track` (parked)
Footer	one	`--z-surface`, `--z-border`
PoweredByFlowForge	one	`site/public/flowforge-logo.svg` @28px, `--z-text-tertiary`

FlowForge

DRAWING TITLE
6 · Component inventory

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§07 7 · Imagery & iconography direction

The page ships **zero raster images.** Everything below is HTML, CSS, or an SVG already staged in `site/public/`. That is not a compromise forced by an empty asset folder — it is the right answer for this product, and each of the three decisions below explains why.

7.1 Decision one — the terminal views are rendered in HTML/CSS, and every one carries a visible mockup caption

The problem. Zerado is not runnable by a visitor yet. There is no screenshot, and `decisions.md` records that faking one is out of bounds. But a grey placeholder box in the hero would waste the single most persuasive slot on the page, for an audience that judges a terminal product by whether its terminal looks right.

The decision. All three terminal views are **real HTML/CSS**, amber-on-black, JetBrains Mono, using the brand's own state colours and glyphs — and each is wrapped in a `<figure>` whose **visible** `<figcaption>` **states it is a mockup and not a screenshot.**

Why this is better than an image even if we had one:

	RENDERED HTML/CSS	A SCREENSHOT PNG
Bytes	0	80–300 KB, the LCP element
Crisp at 1920 and at 375	yes, it is text	no, it is pixels
Selectable / searchable / translatable	yes	no
Screen-reader accessible	yes, real text	only via `alt`
Honest today	yes, and labelled	no such asset exists
Cost to update when the product ships	change a row	re-shoot and re-optimise

The caption is load-bearing and non-negotiable. Without it this is a fake screenshot, which is precisely what the customer ruled out. And the caption needs no new copy, because `content/landing-copy.md` already wrote it — each image slot's alt text is exactly the honest sentence required. So:

> ***Rule: every mockup figure's visible `<figcaption>` is that figure's `alt` text from `content/landing-copy.md`, verbatim.*** *The `<figure>` takes `role="img"` and `aria-labelledby` pointing at the `<figcaption>`, so a screen reader announces it once rather than twice.*

For §01 that reads, on screen, in `--z-text-tertiary` at 13px directly under the frame:

> *An illustration of Zerado's terminal library view. This is a mockup of the planned interface, not a screenshot — the program isn't runnable by visitors yet.*

Zero authored copy. The disclosure is visible on every mockup on the page, in the content team's own words.

7.2 The line this page draws — names are facts, artwork is property

The terminal frames name real games (`Hollow Knight`, `Celeste`, `Disco Elysium`, `Dark Souls III`, `Hades`, `Chrono Trigger`) as plain text in a list. The cover grid shows **no real cover art at all.** That is not an inconsistency; it is the distinction that matters:

- A **title is a fact** about a library, used nominatively, as every storefront, review site and backlog tracker does. Naming a game in a list of games is what the product literally is.
- **Cover artwork is a copyrighted work.** Reproducing a dozen of them on a commercial page is a different act entirely.

Using real titles also makes the frames credible in a way invented titles never could — and inventing plausible game titles carries its own collision risk. The six titles chosen span four states and both acquisition paths (five synced, one `PHYSICAL`), so the mockup proves the product's claims rather than decorating them.

7.3 The three terminal frames, specified

Shared chassis for all three:

```
┌ chrome bar: title (mono 13px --z-text-tertiary) ····· counter (right) ┐
├ parked scanner track: 2px, --z-scanner-track, pip at rest (see §7.6)    ┤
│ screen: --z-bg #05060A, padding 12px @<768 / 16px @768 / 24px @≥1280    │
│ rows …                                                                  │
├ keybar: mono 13px --z-text-tertiary                                      ┤
└ 1px --z-border-strong, --z-radius-md, --z-elevation-2 ──────────────────┘
```

Column budgets — derived from JetBrains Mono's measured 0.600em advance, not estimated:

VIEWPORT	CONTENT	FRAME CHROME	INTERIOR	MONO	COLUMNS
375	335px	2px border + 2×12 pad	309px	13px (7.80px/cell)	**39**
768	720px	2px + 2×16	686px	13px	**87**
1280	1180px	2px + 2×24	1130px	15px (9.00px/cell)	**125**
1920	1180px (capped)	2px + 2×24	1130px	15px	**125**

Mono size **steps** (13px below 1280, 15px at and above) rather than fluidly clamping, so the column budget is an exact integer at every measured viewport and the gate can check it.

TF-1 — `library`, §01 hero, `live` chassis.

Row grid, one line at ≥768: `glyph 2ch | gap 2 | title 1fr (min 18ch) | platform 10ch | hours 6ch | state 12ch`

GLYPH	TITLE	PLATFORM	HOURS	STATE
◐	Hollow Knight	STEAM	42h	IN PROGRESS
◉	Celeste	STEAM	11h	ZERADO
○	Disco Elysium	GOG	0h	NOT STARTED
⊘	Dark Souls III	STEAM	6h	ABANDONED
◐	Hades	STEAM	28h	IN PROGRESS
○	Chrono Trigger	PHYSICAL	—	NOT STARTED

All four states appear, which pre-teaches §05; one row is `PHYSICAL`, which pre-teaches §06. Row 2 (`Celeste`, ZERADO) is the `selected` row — `--z-surface-overlay` fill and a `▸` caret — so the earned cyan sits at the frame's optical centre.

Chrome: `zerado — library` left, `412 games · 6 zerado` right. Keybar: `↑↓ move · enter open · m mood · / filter · q quit`.

At ≥1280 the frame is **two-pane**: list 80 cols | `|` divider 3 cols | `TONIGHT` rail 42 cols holding the four state counts (`○ NOT STARTED 288 · ◐ IN PROGRESS 9 · ◉ ZERADO 6 · ⊘ ABANDONED 109` — summing to 412, matching the chrome counter and copy §03's "You own 400 games" order of magnitude). At 768–1279 the rail is **dropped whole**, not compressed.

At <768 each row becomes **two lines**:

```
◐ Hollow Knight
  IN PROGRESS · STEAM · 42h
```

Measured longest two-line row: `NOT STARTED · PHYSICAL · —` = 28 cells ≤ 39 ✓. Titles truncate with `…` as a backstop but none of the six needs it. **The state label never disappears** — dropping it at narrow widths would break the brand's co-render rule (colour AND glyph AND label) on the product's most-used component.

TF-2 — `mood picker`, §04, `still`. Two columns: mood list | matches.

```
┌ zerado — pick a mood ──────────────────────────── 4 moods ┐
│  ▸ Mindless grind              ◐ Hades                     │
│    Story rich, kind of sad     ◉ Celeste                   │
│    Quick fifteen minutes       ○ Chrono Trigger            │
│    Tactical, full focus        ◐ Hollow Knight             │
└ ↑↓ move · enter pick · esc back ──────────────────────────┘
```

Mood names verbatim from copy §04's four card titles, in the copy's order. Longest is `Story rich, kind of sad` = 23 cells; at 39 cols the two columns do not fit side by side, so at <768 the frame **stacks**: mood list, a `──` rule, then matches. Both parts survive.

TF-3 — `game detail`, §09, `still`. One game, one screen:

```
┌ zerado — Hollow Knight ──────────────────────── steam ┐
│  ◐ IN PROGRESS          42h played                    │
│                                                       │
│  MOODS   tactical, full focus · story rich            │
│  PRICE   $15 today   ·   low $8 (3 months ago)        │
│          maybe wait                                   │
│                                                       │
│  SINOPSE  A short plot summary lands here once        │
│           enrichment is wired in.                     │
└ e edit · m mood · p price history · q back ──────────┘
```

Price figures are copy §07's worked example exactly — the page never shows two different example prices. Mood tags are copy §04's titles. The `SINOPSE` row does double duty: it demonstrates the detail view and it shows the Portuguese word in situ, which copy §06 explains once. Longest line is 38 cells — fits 39 at 375 ✓ with no reflow needed.

Caption on all three: the figure's own alt text from copy, verbatim (§7.1).

7.4 The grid horizon (hero backdrop)

Two stacked CSS layers on the hero's `::before`, both `aria-hidden`, occupying the hero's bottom 38% and masked to zero opacity above that:

1. A perspective plane of `--z-grid-line` `#1A2740` lines — two `repeating-linear-gradient`s, `perspective: 320px` + `rotateX(76deg)`, converging to a horizon at the mask boundary.
2. A `radial-gradient` bloom of `--z-primary` at **6% alpha** centred on the horizon, capped at 10% — the amber phosphor haze.

Verified: even at the 10% cap, the composited ground is `#1E1709` and `--z-text` still measures **15.24:1** over it, `--z-text-secondary` **8.56:1**. No text is placed there anyway, but the budget is checked so a later change cannot quietly break it.

Static. It does not scroll, parallax, or animate. An animated synthwave grid is the single fastest way to turn retro-future into retro-kitsch, and it would burn paint budget for it.

7.5 Decision two — the cover grid uses art-directed tiles, not real game covers

The customer asked for "nice game images to illustrate the page." He is not getting a grid of real game covers, and here is exactly why — and what he is getting instead, which is better.

Why not real covers. Three independent reasons, any one of which would be enough:

1. **Cover art is copyrighted.** This is a commercial page — `decisions.md` Q6 puts an affiliate revenue model in the footer. Embedding a dozen publishers' artwork on a page that earns commission is a legal exposure the customer would inherit from us. We do not hand a customer a liability inside a deliverable.
2. **The page is required to be fully self-contained.** No external image requests. Real covers would mean either hotlinking a storefront CDN (an external request, and a dependency that 404s the day someone re-arts a game) or redistributing the files ourselves, which is the same copyright problem with extra steps.
3. `decisions.md` **flags IGDB as an open commercial-licensing risk** — cover art and *sinopse* depend on a partnership that does not exist yet. Shipping a marketing page built on the exact asset class whose licence is unresolved would be building a second problem on top of the first.

What it is instead, and why it is stronger. Twelve **art-directed cover tiles**, composed in CSS in the Zerado palette. A grid of real 2020s marketing covers on an 80s-retro-future page would fight the page — twelve different studios' art directions, twelve different colour temperatures, in a palette engineered to be exactly six colours. The tiles carry the *argument* of the section (shelf rhythm, density, one hand-added item sitting as an equal) without importing twelve conflicting aesthetics.

Specification:

- **Aspect ratio** `3 / 4` — the box-art proportion; it is what makes the grid read as covers before a single word is processed.
- **Grid:** 3 columns at 375, 4 at 768, 6 at ≥1280. Gap `--z-space-3` (12px) at 375, `--z-space-4` (16px) above. 12 tiles divides evenly into 4 / 3 / 2 rows — the shelf never ends ragged.
- **Four treatments × three hue keys = twelve unique tiles.** No two adjacent tiles (in any of the three column counts) share both treatment and hue.

TREATMENT	COMPOSITION	READS AS
A · grid horizon	perspective grid converging to a lit horizon line; hue-keyed glow above it	the synthwave beat, in miniature
B · scanline field	`repeating-linear-gradient` scanlines over a hue wash, one bright pip off-centre	a CRT holding a signal
C · brushed panel	a diagonal `--z-steel` band with a machined slot, on `--z-void`	the DeLorean panel
D · phosphor arc	an off-centre radial disc, hue-keyed, fading into the void	a readout at rest

Hue keys are `--z-primary` amber, `--z-accent` cyan, `--z-orchid-500` orchid. Fixed sequence, left to right, top to bottom (also recorded in `blueprint.tokens.json` so the gate can diff it):

```
 1 A-amber   2 B-cyan    3 C-steel   4 D-orchid   5 B-amber   6 A-cyan
 7 D-steel   8 C-orchid  9 B-orchid 10 A-steel   11 D-amber  12 C-cyan
```

- **Every tile carries a** `PlatformTag` at its bottom-left: `STEAM`, `GOG`, `EA`, `PS`, or `PHYSICAL`. Distribution: 6 STEAM, 2 GOG, 1 EA, 2 PS, **1 PHYSICAL** (tile 9). The tag is **plain text on a solid** `--z-surface` **plate**, never floating on the artwork — so its contrast is fixed at 7.62:1 (steel) regardless of what the tile behind it is doing. That is the whole reason for the plate.
- **The** `PHYSICAL` **tag co-renders** — amber `#FFB000` (10.59:1) + the `▣` glyph + the word, so it is distinguishable without colour, exactly like a product state.
- **Tiles carry no titles.** No invented game names, no real ones. The section's argument is carried by copy, by the tag distribution, and by density.
- **The grid is** `role="img"` with `aria-labelledby` on its caption, children `aria-hidden`. A screen reader gets copy §06's alt text once, not twelve decorative divs.
- Non-interactive: no hover, no link, no lightbox.
- Caption: copy §06 alt text verbatim + one design-authored line — `Cover tiles are illustrative artwork, not real game covers.` **Flagged:** this single sentence is the one string on the page not drawn from `content/landing-copy.md`. It exists because this decision requires disclosure. Content may re-word it; the requirement to disclose stays.

7.6 Decision three — motion, and the synthwave question

The founder wants the feel of 80s synthwave. The page carries that in the visual and motion register, not in audio. No audio file, no autoplay, no play button: browsers block autoplay, sound-on-load is an accessibility failure and a trust failure, and an audio asset would dominate the byte budget of a page that currently ships zero images. What actually transmits the feeling on a landing page is the **scanner sweep, the grid horizon, the neon glow and the amber CRT readout** — and this page has all four.

Total motion inventory — nine entries, and that is the complete list.

#	MOTION	WHERE	DURATION / EASING	PREFERS-REDUCED-MOTION: REDUCE
1	**ScannerRule sweep** — the signature	**§01 bottom edge only**, page-wide count: **1**	2400ms, `--z-ease-scanner`, alternate, infinite, pip 18% of track	**Pip parks at track centre, full opacity, travel stops.** Never hidden — brand §7.3: the lit slot is identity, the travel is decoration.
2	Parked scanner tracks	TF-1/2/3 chrome bars + §15 top edge (4 instances)	**none — static by design**	unchanged
3	CTAButton primary hover	3 buttons	140ms `--z-ease-standard` (fill, glow)	1ms
4	CTAButton secondary hover	1 button	140ms `--z-ease-standard` (edge, label, glow)	1ms

#	MOTION	WHERE	DURATION / EASING	PREFERS-REDUCED-MOTION: REDUCE
5	Focus ring appearance	all 15 focusable elements	90ms `--z-duration-instant`	1ms — **the ring itself always appears; only its transition collapses**
6	NavLink / FooterLink underline	4 links	140ms `--z-ease-standard`	1ms
7	FAQItem expand	6 items	220ms `--z-ease-out`	1ms
8	FAQItem collapse	6 items	140ms `--z-ease-in`	1ms
9	GridHorizon	§01	**static**	unchanged

Not present, deliberately: scroll-triggered reveals, parallax, marquees, typewriter effects, counting numbers, hover lift/translate on anything, carousels, autoplaying anything, spring or bounce easing of any kind. Brand §7.2: *mechanical, not playful. This is a machined object.*

The reduced-motion implementation is a global collapse plus one explicit re-park, because a blanket `animation: none` would leave the pip wherever the cascade dropped it:

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {
  *, *::before, *::after {
    animation-duration: 1ms !important;
    animation-iteration-count: 1 !important;
    transition-duration: 1ms !important;
    scroll-behavior: auto !important;
  }
  .z-scanner::after {                  /* re-park, do not hide */
    animation: none !important;
    left: calc(50% - (var(--z-scanner-pip-width) / 2));
    opacity: 1;
  }
}
```

A scanner sweep that cannot be turned off is an accessibility defect — and one that is *hidden* under reduced motion is a brand defect. This does neither.

7.7 Iconography — there isn't any

No icon set is introduced on this page. Not Feather, not Lucide, not Heroicons, not an emoji. Everything an icon would have done is done by:

- **the brand's four state glyphs** (`○ ◐ ◉ ⊘`) — already designed, already CVD-verified at ΔE ≥ 11.9, already the product's own vocabulary;
- `▣` for the `PHYSICAL` tag, drawn from the same geometric family;

- **mono readout labels** — a terminal labels things with words, which is exactly the register;
- **2px amber tick rules** in §08 where a list would otherwise reach for a checkmark.

Adding a general icon set would import a second visual language with a second set of proportions and a second licence, to solve problems this page does not have. The glyphs come from the font stack already loaded, so they cost nothing and can never fail to load independently of the text they annotate.

7.8 SVG assets used

ASSET	WHERE	SIZE
`site/public/logo.svg` (viewBox `0 0 364 64`)	Nav	140px ≥768 · 120px @375
`site/public/favicon.svg`	`<link rel="icon">`	16–32px
`site/public/flowforge-logo.svg` (viewBox `0 0 36 36`)	Footer `PoweredByFlowForge`	28px

`logo-mark.svg`, `logo-mono-white.svg` and `logo-mono-black.svg` are **not used on this page** — the page is dark-native and full-colour on dark is the primary variant (brand §3.6). No OG image file exists (`content/seo.md` records this); the build emits no `og:image` rather than pointing at a file that 404s.

§08 8 · Accessibility & motion notes

Target: **WCAG 2.2 Level AA**, which the brand sets as its standard. Most of this page lands AAA on contrast because the palette was built that way.

8.1 Contrast pairings as token pairs

Cited values (**bold**) are published in `brand-manual.md` §4.2 and are carried, not re-estimated. Unbolded values are pairs the manual does not publish because they involve a non-default surface; they are computed with the same method, which was verified to reproduce all sixteen of the manual's own figures exactly.

PAIRING	TOKENS	RATIO	REQ.	VERDICT
Body prose	`--z-text` on `--z-surface`	**16.65**	4.5	AAA
Body prose on ground	`--z-text` on `--z-bg`	17.37	4.5	AAA
Subhead / FAQ answers	`--z-text-secondary` on `--z-surface`	**9.36**	4.5	AAA
Card body	`--z-text-secondary` on `--z-surface-raised`	8.41	4.5	AAA
Captions, microcopy	`--z-text-tertiary` on `--z-surface`	**6.15**	4.5	AA
Caption on raised	`--z-text-tertiary` on `--z-surface-raised`	5.53	4.5	AA
Worst text pair on the page	`--z-text-tertiary` on `--z-surface-overlay`	**4.89**	4.5	AA
H1 / H2 display	`--z-text` on `--z-bg`	17.37	3.0 (large)	AAA
Emphasised heading clause	`--z-primary` on `--z-surface`	**10.59**	3.0	AAA
Primary CTA label	`--z-accent-contrast` on `--z-accent`	**12.68**	4.5	AAA
Primary CTA hover label	`--z-accent-contrast` on `#8CF0FF`	15.45	4.5	AAA
Secondary CTA label	`--z-text` on `--z-bg`	17.37	4.5	AAA
Secondary CTA hover label	`--z-primary` on `--z-bg`	**11.05**	4.5	AAA
Links	`--z-text-link` on `--z-surface`	**12.15**	4.5	AAA
Link hover	`--z-text-link-hover` on `--z-surface`	**14.81**	4.5	AAA
Terminal amber readout	`--z-primary` on `--z-bg`	**11.05**	4.5	AAA
State: NOT STARTED	`--z-steel` on `--z-bg`	7.95	4.5	AAA
State: IN PROGRESS	`--z-primary` on `--z-bg`	**11.05**	4.5	AAA
State: ZERADO	`--z-accent` on `--z-bg`	**12.68**	4.5	AAA
State: ABANDONED	`--z-orchid-500` on `--z-bg`	7.53	4.5	AAA

PAIRING	TOKENS	RATIO	REQ.	VERDICT
Roadmap `PLANNED` label	`--z-steel` on `--z-surface-raised`	6.85	4.5	AA
Price verdict	`--z-primary` on `--z-surface-raised`	9.53	4.5	AAA
Cover-tile platform tag	`--z-steel` on `--z-surface` plate	**7.62**	4.5	AAA
Cover-tile PHYSICAL tag	`--z-primary` on `--z-surface` plate	**10.59**	4.5	AAA
Hero text over amber bloom (worst case, 10%)	`--z-text` on `#1E1709`	15.24	4.5	AAA
Focus ring	`--z-focus-ring` on `--z-bg`	**12.68**	3.0	AAA
Focus ring on raised	`--z-focus-ring` on `--z-surface-raised`	10.93	3.0	AAA
Control edge	`--z-border-strong` on `--z-surface`	**4.08**	3.0 (1.4.11)	pass
Control edge, worst surface	`--z-border-strong` on `--z-surface-overlay`	3.24	3.0	pass
Scanner pip on its track	`--z-scanner` on `--z-scanner-track`	3.63	n/a — decorative	pass

8.2 CVD and colour-independence

The four state colours were verified by the brand (Viénot/Brettel/Mollon dichromat simulation, CIEDE2000): worst pair `zerado × abandoned` under deuteranopia at **ΔE 11.9**, every pair over 10 in every model. This page adds no new meaning-bearing colour, so that verification carries.

No information on this page is conveyed by colour alone. Every state carries colour + glyph + label; the `PHYSICAL` tag carries colour + `▣` + word; the roadmap status carries colour + `○` + `PLANNED`; the live-vs-planned store rows carry colour + `◉`/`○` + position under a labelled heading. Under `forced-colors: active` the page surrenders colour to the OS and stays fully readable: glyph and label carry everything, and terminal frames keep a 1px border so they do not dissolve into the background.

8.3 Contrast pairings I rejected before they entered this blueprint

Five pairings were designed, measured, failed, and replaced. They are recorded so nobody re-derives them:

REJECTED PAIRING	RATIO	INTENDED USE	REPLACED WITH
`--z-amber-900` `#8A5E00` on `--z-surface-raised`	**3.06** ×	The roadmap `PLANNED` label — "unlit amber" is the obvious semantic for *not yet*.	`--z-steel` `#A5A29B` at **6.85**. `--z-amber-900` survives as the status **track** fill, which holds no text.

REJECTED PAIRING	RATIO	INTENDED USE	REPLACED WITH
`--z-cyan-900` `#0B6C7D` on `--z-surface-raised`	**2.87** ×	The §06 planned-store rows (PlayStation / GOG / EA) — "unlit cyan" for not-connected-yet.	`--z-text-tertiary` `#8492A8` at **5.53**, with the `○` glyph carrying *planned*.
`--z-scanner-500` `#FF2E2E` on `--z-surface-overlay`	**4.17** ×	The §07 price verdict — red for "don't buy".	`--z-primary` `#FFB000` at **9.53**. It is also semantically right: "maybe wait" is a readout, not an alarm, and the brand reserves scanner red for motion and alarm.
`--z-slate-500` `#64748B` on `--z-surface-overlay`	**3.24** ×	Caption text inside overlay-filled cards.	`--z-text-secondary` `#A9B5C7` at **7.43**. `--z-slate-500` stays what the brand made it: a UI boundary, where 3.24 satisfies 1.4.11.
`--z-border` `#2A3342` as a control edge	**1.53** ×	MoodCard / PriceCard / PhaseCard edges — it is the prettier hairline.	`--z-border-strong` `#64748B` (≥3.24 on every surface). `--z-border` is restricted to hairlines *between content blocks* (§02, §14, §16), which is the one use the brand permits.

8.4 Structure, landmarks and focus order

```
<a class="z-skip" href="#main">Skip to content</a>
<header role="banner">   <nav> lockup · GitHub · Join the waitlist </nav>
</header>
<main id="main">         sections 01 … 15 </main>
<footer role="contentinfo"> section 16 </footer>
```

- **One** `<h1>`, in §01. Every other section heading is `<h2>`. No level is skipped; there are no `<h3>`s used structurally (MoodCard titles are `<p>` with H3 *styling*, because they are labels inside a card, not document structure).
- Sections **with** a visible heading get `<section aria-labelledby="…">` and become named regions. Sections **without** one (§02, §15) are plain `<section id="…">` with **no invented** `aria-label` — a landmark named with a string that appears nowhere on the page is a fabrication, and an unnamed non-region is the correct alternative.
- **Focus order is DOM order**, and DOM order is visual order at every breakpoint. Nothing on this page uses `order`, `row-reverse`, or a positive `tabindex`. The full tab sequence is: `skip → nav GitHub → nav CTA → hero CTA primary → hero CTA secondary → [any overflowing terminal screen] → FAQ ×6 → closing CTA → footer waitlist → footer GitHub → footer contact`.
- **Nothing on this page traps focus** — there is no modal, no dialog, no overlay, no auto-focusing element.
- `<html lang="en">`. The two Portuguese words (`zerado`, `sinopse`) are wrapped `<span lang="pt-BR">` on the occurrences copy marks as the explained first appearance, so a screen reader pronounces them in Portuguese rather than

mangling them in English — which is the entire point of keeping them (decisions.md Q5-b).

- `<title>`, meta description, canonical, OG and Twitter tags come from `content/seo.md` verbatim. No `og:image` is emitted, because no such asset exists.
- Terminal-frame decorative characters (box-drawing runs, the parked scanner track, the sparkline) are `aria-hidden`; the rows' text is real text and is read normally.

8.5 Performance posture (design-side)

- **LCP candidate is the hero `<h1>` text.** No image can outrank it, because the page has none.
- **Preload three font files** — `Orbitron-latin.woff2` (the LCP element's face), `SpaceGrotesk-latin.woff2`, `JetBrainsMono-latin.woff2`. The two `latin-ext` subsets are left to lazy `unicode-range` resolution; the page's copy is Latin-1 apart from the box-drawing and state glyphs, which resolve from the mono `latin` subset and the system fallback.
- **CLS defence:** terminal frames set an explicit `min-block-size` computed from row count × line-height, cover tiles set `aspect-ratio: 3/4`, and phone frames set fixed dimensions — so a font swap or a slow paint cannot shift the page. Nothing on the page is injected after paint, because there is no script to inject it.
- **INP** is structurally near-zero: the only interactions are native link activation and a native `<details>` toggle.

---

§09 9 · What the build may not change without coming back here

1. The sixteen section ids, and their order.
2. Any string from `content/landing-copy.md` — wire by reference, never retype, never re-word.
3. The four breakpoints — 375 / 768 / 1280 / 1920.
4. The rule that every mockup carries a **visible** caption naming it a mockup.
5. The absence of real game cover art, of a donate/sponsor control, of the community-source name banned by ratified decision Q4 (that name is deliberately not written anywhere in this repository — see `docs/REDACTIONS.md`), and of any roadmap status other than `Planned`.
6. The focus ring, on any element, in any state.
7. The reduced-motion behaviour of the scanner: **parks, never hides.**

Form follows the brief. The design is the brief made visible.

FlowForge
ENGINEERED ARTIFACT

DRAWING TITLE

Zerado — Landing Page Design Blueprint

DISCIPLINE	SHEET	DWG NO.	REV	STATUS
DESIGN	12 OF 12	FP-LP-DESIGN-01	A · 2026-08-24	IN REVIEW

LEGEND — Ink — text & headings · Canvas — surface · Accent — emphasis · Highlight — rules

Rendered from blueprint.md

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